ACADEMIC REGULATIONS FOR MS/MPhil PROGRAMS

Version 4.0

Applicability: Effective from Academic Session Fall 2022

Superior University
17 km Raiwind Road, Lahore

REGULATIONS

GOVERNING ADMISSION, REGISTRATION AND EXAMINATION OF MS/ M. Phil PROGRAMS 4.0

The Superior University shall offer courses leading to the degrees of Master of Science, abbreviated as MS, and Master of Philosophy, abbreviated as M.Phil or otherwise as prescribed for in the subjects as approved by the Academic Council from time to time. Applications for admission to various courses of study shall be invited through advertisement and admission shall be made on the basis of merit.

The following Regulations are prescribed to govern the matters relating to the admissions, registrations and examinations for the MS/M.Phil level programs. These regulations shall apply to MS/M.Phil candidates admitted in a post-graduate Department/Center, Institute or constituent / affiliated institute of The Superior University, Lahore.

Wherever applicable the regulations prescribed from time to time by the professional councils/bodies such as Pakistan Engineering Council (PEC), Pakistan Medical Commission (formerly known as Medical and Dental Council), Pharmacy Council of Pakistan (PCP), National Computing Education Accreditation Council (NCEAC), National Business Education Accreditation Council (NBEAC), Pakistan Council of Architects and Town Planners (PACTP) shall be applicable.

DEFINITIONS

In these regulations, unless there is anything repugnant in the subject or ontext:

- "**University**" means The Superior University, Lahore.
- "**Academic Advisor**" means a Superior University teacher appointed as academic advisor for the class/ batch/semester by the concerned Dean.
- "**Academic Council**" means the Academic Council of the Superior University.
- "**Academic Year**" of the Superior University shall comprise of two regular semesters (Fall and Spring), each of which shall normally of 16-18 weeks including 1-2 weeks for the terminal examinations of the semester. During the summer break, there may be a Summer Session of not exceeding nine (9) weeks including the terminal examinations of the session. The contact hours per week during a Summer Session will be doubled to ensure that a course is completely taught with half of the duration as compared with a regular (Fall/Spring) Semester.
- **"Board of Advanced Studies and Research"**means the Board of Advanced Studies and Research (BASR) of the Superior University.
- **"Chairperson"**means Head of Board of Studies equivalent to the position of Professor or Associate Professor of the Department. Provided that where there is no Professor or Associate Professor in the Department, the Dean himself shall act as the Chairperson.

- **"Commencement of Semester/Session"** means the day of start of classes for the semester/session as prescribed in the Academic Calendar of the Superior University published from time to time.
- "**Controller of Examinations**" means the Controller of Examination (COE) of the Superior University.
- "**Credit Course**" means a course of study, successful completion of which shall be the requirement for award of the degree. The grade obtained in a credit course shall appear on the transcript.
- **"Credit Hour"**means teaching a theory course for 50-60 minutes of classroom per week throughout the semester. One Credit Hour in laboratory /Library research /Museum /Clinical Wards would require contact of two-three (2-3) hours of laboratory work / library research / Museum / Clinical Wards per week throughout the semester.

  Explanation: The credit hours are denoted by two digits within brackets with a hyphen in between. The first (left side) digit represents the theory part while the second (right side) digit represents the laboratory / research work / Museum / Clinical Wards. Thus 3(3-0) means three credit hours of theory while 4(3- 1) means a total of four credit hours, of which, three credit hours are of theory while one credit hour is for laboratory / research / Museum / Clinical Wards. The weekly contact hours of a 3(3-0) Credit hours course will be three, while the contact hours of 4(3-1) course will be five to six while the contact hours of 3(1-2) will be five to seven.

- **"Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA)"**means the weighted average of the Grade Points earned for all the credit courses in all the semester attended.
- **"Dean"**means the Dean of a Faculty of the Superior University.
- **"Incharge / HoD/ Program Leader"**means the "Incharge / HoD/Program Leader" of the Program appointed by the Superior University in a prescribed manner. The term includes the Chairman of the Department as well, where applicable.
- **"Department"** means a teaching department, a University, a school, a center of the Superior University with whatsoever name called, or constituent or affiliated institute of the Superior University, or an academic institution with which the Superior University has a valid Memorandum of Understanding.
- **"External Examiner"**means a subject expert (outside the Superior University or any of its departments) to evaluate the thesis and/or to take the viva-voce examinations of research students of the program.
- **"Faculty"**means the Faculty of the Superior University.
- **"Faculty or Departmental Research Committee"**means research committee of each department/faculty offering Research program (PhD/MS/MPhil) and whose primary job is to take decisions or propose suggestion related to research related matters in their respective departments/faculties.

- **"Grade Point"** means the points (numerical value) associated with each letter grade.
- **"Grade"** means the letter grade earned by a student in a course depending on his/her performance in that course.
- "**Non-Credit Course**" means a course registered by the student or prescribed by the concerned Department, which is not to be counted towards the minimum degree requirements. The grade of a non-credit course shall appear on the transcript with a special mark and it shall not be used in calculation of the SGPA/CGPA.
- "**Prescribed**" means prescribed by the Statues, Regulations and Rules of the Superior University.
- **"Program"** means a MS/MPhil Level program leading to a degree.
- **"Rector"** means the Rector of the Superior University.
- **"Registrar"** means the Registrar of the Superior University.
- **"Semester Grade Point Average (SGPA)"** means the weighted average of the Grade Points earned for all the credit courses in a single semester.
- **"Student"** means a student enrolled in MS/MPhil Level program of the Superior University.
- **"Synopsis"**means a written research proposal to be submitted by the student in partial fulfillment of the program.
- **"Thesis"**means a written report resulting from original research to be submitted by the student in partial fulfillment of the program.
- **"University / Institute / University"**means the Superior University.
- **"Viva Voce"** means oral defense as a partial requirement of MS/MPhil.

ADMISSION TO THE PROGRAM

- To be eligible for admission to the MS/MPhil program, a candidate

  1. should possess a Bachelor's or Master's degree of minimum of 16 years of schooling or an equivalent qualification (BS-4 Years) in the relevant discipline from a recognized University/Degree Awarding Institute (DAI). Provided that the degree has been passed, meeting the required criteria set by the Higher Education Commission for 16 years education.
  2. shall have obtained a minimum cumulative grade point average (CGPA) of 2.00 on the 4.00 scale in the semester system or a minimum of 50% marks in the annual system in the last qualifying degree. However, a Faculty may devise more stringent criteria for any of its programs in the prescribed manner through its Board of Faculty.
  3. must have passed the Superior University Admission test or GAT (General) or equivalent test as prescribed by the HEC.

- Each candidate shall make an application for admission in response to an advertisement by the University on a prescribed form along with the documents specified in the form.
- The admission to the degree program shall be made on the basis of cumulative merit to be determined from the previous academic record, prescribed test(s) and interview.
- Anyone who has been rusticated or expelled by a university, degree awarding institute or University for misconduct or for use of unfair means (including plagiarism) in the examinations or for any offence involving moral turpitude shall not be eligible for admission in any program of the Superior University.
- Each Faculty shall have a Postgraduate Admission Committee for its program(s). This committee shall suggest criteria for admission from time to time and accept, scrutinize and evaluate the applications for admission, determine merit, finalize and recommend admissions for approval of the Dean for each intake session. Admission in a program shall be based only on criteria approved by the BASR and duly endorsed by the Academic Council.
- The committee shall be approved by the Rector on recommendations of the Dean. The committee shall consist of the following and the quorum for a meeting of the committee shall be minimum three (3) members:

1	**Chairman/ Gonvener**	**Dean of the Faculty Concerned**
2	**Members**	**Three faculty members from various programs offered by the Faculty having PhD/MS/MPhil qualification provided that at least two of the faculty members must be PhD**
3	**Technical Member**	**Two nominated by the BASR.**

- The selected candidate shall be issued an admission offer letter by the Admission Office.
- After receiving the admission offer letter, the candidate shall be required to pay the prescribed admission and other fees within the stipulated time period for confirmation his/her admission in the program, failing which his/her candidature shall stand cancelled.

CURRICULUM OF PROGRAM

Each department shall develop the curriculum for each of its programs through the relevant Board of Studies and submit it through the concerned Board of Faculty to the BASR and the Academic Council for approval. Such curriculum shall become effective from the date of its approval by the Academic Council or as may be prescribed. The curriculum of a program shall normally consist of the objectives and scope of the program, structure/requirements of the program, scheme of studies and syllabi of the courses.

- A program shall normally comprise of a minimum of 24 credit hours of the coursework and of a minimum of 6 credit hours of research/project work. The research work shall be mandatory for the conferment of the research degrees/awards.
- The requirements for the program shall be completed within the time period specified. The minimum duration is 3 or 4 semesters (i.e. 1.5 or 2 years) for full time students and minimum of 8 semesters (i.e. 4 years) for a part time student. The maximum time limit is 3 years for full time students and 6 years for part time students, if program is offered. However, in special circumstances on request of the student and consent of the supervisor, the BASR may allow extension for up to one year only on recommendations of the concerned Board of Faculty.
- The teacher concerned shall issue the course outline to the students, which normally includes the objectives of the course, course contents and their weekly lecture schedules, assessments and evaluations criteria, attendance policy, reading material and any other information important for successful completion of the course.
- Each student shall follow the curriculum of the program as may be prescribed by the Academic Council from time to time.
- English shall be the medium of instructions, thesis writing and examinations for all the subjects except oriental languages, in which case it may be either the language itself or English.

REGISTRATION AND ENROLLMENT

University Registration

1. A student seeking admission in a degree program shall register himself/herself through his/her department with the Registrar within the dates notified for registration, failing which his/her admission may be declared as cancelled.
2. The Registrar shall issue a University registration number to each student.

Course Registration and Semester Enrollment

1. The department shall complete the course registration and semester enrollment of its students within two weeks before the commencement of a semester/session.
2. A student shall register for the courses offered by the department on a prescribed Course Registration and Semester Enrollment Form (or through UMS) in consultation with his/her Academic Advisor.
3. A regular student shall register a minimum of 09 credit hours and a maximum of 12 credit hours in a regular Fall/Spring semester. Provided that in exceptional cases, on the advice of the Academic Advisor/Supervisor, Chairman of the Department may decide the course load for the student in lower or upper case. Moreover, summer session shall be offered as per the decision of the management keeping in view its feasibility.
4. The student shall deposit his/her fees and dues of a semester/session before commencement of the semester/session. The course registration and semester enrollment form shall not be accepted if the student has any outstanding fees and dues of previous the semester/session.
5. If a student fails to register the courses before the commencement of the semester, the Dean on recommendations of the Supervisor/Academic Advisor through HOD/In-Charge Postgraduate Programs may allow the student to register for courses within two week after the commencement of semester subject to the payment of late fees as prescribed by the Department and approved by the University from time to time.

Add/Drop of Courses

- A student may add or drop his/her enrolled course(s) on the recommendations of the Supervisor/Academic Advisor and approval of the concerned CoD/ HoD/In-Charge PostgraduateProgram within two weeks of the commencement of semester. However, the minimum credit hour requirement as mentioned in para 7-b.iii needs to be met.

- Add/Drop of course(s) for a student who is repeating any course(s) or is on academic deficiency (with a low SGPA and/or CGPA than the minimum requirement) may be allowed by the Dean on recommendations of the Academic Advisor through the HoD/In-Charge Postgraduate Programs.
- The student shall deposit the dues for the additional credit hours course(s) accordingly. In case of drop of course(s) the amount paid shall be adjusted according to the policy of the Superior University.

Freezing of Semester/Readmission

1. A student dropping all the registered courses or choosing not to register in any course for a semester up to first two weeks of commencement of a semester shall be required to apply to his/her Dean for freezing of the same semester only.
2. No freezing shall be allowed for the first semester of registration and enrollment in the Department/University and for an offered summer session. However, under special circumstances freezing of first semester can be considered with the approval of Dean. Special circumstance may be any one of the following:
    - Iddat
    - Accident of the student
    - Death in the immediate family (first blood relatives)
    - Any other subject to acceptance on justified rationale
3. The frozen semester(s) shall be counted towards the maximum period allowed for the degree program.
4. A student, who neither registers any courses for a semester nor requests for freezing of the semester, shall deem to have abandoned his/her program. However, he/she may be allowed to reinstate his/her program in a subsequent semester/ session on his/her request, provided he/she has sufficient time to complete the requirements of the program within the maximum time period allowed from the date of his/her initial admission in the program. He/she shall be required to pay the prescribed reinstatement fee along with other dues of the semester/session.
5. Provided also that if a student does not get reinstated after abandoning the program within the maximum time period allowed for completion of the program from the date of his/her initial admission, he/she may be readmitted on his/her request in the same program by the concerned Dean upon recommendations of the HOD/In-Charge Postgraduate Programs. In such a case only 50% of the coursework of the program may be acceptable to rejoin the program. The student has to pay the prescribed re- admission fee of the program along with other dues of the semester/session.

Transfer of Credits/Exemption of Courses

1. A candidate may be allowed to transfer his/her credit hours earned from any other recognized/accredited University/Degree Awarding Institute (DAI) on his/her request along with the admission application to the Department/ University.
2. The transfer of credit application shall be evaluated by the Equivalence Committee of the Faculty concerned on transfer The committee shall consist of three senior Faculty member of the Faculty including HOD/Incharge Postgraduate program concerned.
3. The committee may co-opt one more expert/member, if so desired for a case. The committee shall make its recommendations to the Dean for approval.
4. No credit of a course shall be transferred if the letter grade is less than B (normally with a minimum grade point of 3.00 on the 4.00 scale) earned in the examination under semester system or with a minimum of 60% marks obtained in the annual system.
5. A maximum of 50% of the total credit hours required for completion of the program at the Department/University may be allowed for transfer.
6. The transfer shall normally be sought out on course-by-course basis. The transferable courses corresponding to the core courses of the program shall have at least 70% similarity of the course contents/syllabi on the current scheme of study of the program. However, in case of courses corresponding to the elective courses, the Committee shall evaluate and recommend the transfer of such courses which shall lead to fulfill the overall objectives of the program.
7. The transferred/exempted courses and their credit hours shall appear on the transcript with a description stating the work as transferred/exempted and the name of the University/DAI from where these were originally qualified and earned.
8. The grade and the grade point of the transferred courses shall not be used in calculating the SGPA and CGPA
9. The candidate shall be responsible for providing the migration certificate/ NOC, syllabi of courses, letter grades and the grade points of all the courses that he/she has qualified/earned at the previous University/DAI and shall meet all the admission requirements of the program.

EXAMINATIONS OF COURSEWORK AND ATTENDANCE

- A student shall be evaluated in each course on the basis of periodical quizzes, test(s), assignment(s), individual/group presentations, group discussion(s), term papers, project/laboratory reports and/or otherwise as prescribed during the semester/session and the terminal examination covering the whole course at the end of the semester/session. The examinations/assessments shall be oral and/or in writing. Each course shall carry 100 marks. Breakup of the examination shall be as per policy of the University/ each Faculty.
- The minimum pass marks for each course shall be 60% (C Grade), which shall be the aggregate of the marks obtained during the semester/session and of the terminal examinations.
- If a student absents himself/herself in any assessment (e.g. class quiz, test, etc.) for any reason, no separate examinations/assessment will be arranged for him/her and he/she shall be awarded zero marks for that examinations/assessment. Provided that under exceptional cases as explained above, the teacher concerned may accommodate the request by keeping the record.
- There shall be written examination for each course at the end of each semester/session on the dates fixed by the Controller of Examinations in consultation with the Dean. Prior approval from Dean is required if written examination is replaced with Term paper. The deadline to submit research paper shall be before the commencement of final term examinations and needs to be communicated to Controller of Examinations. The research paper should be passed through the plagiarism detection software. Copy of the Plagiarism report and the submitted paper should be provided to examination department. Provided that the similarity index should not exceed the limits prescribed by the HEC (19 % at the max.)
- A student shall be allowed to appear in the examination provided that he/she:
    1. has been on the rolls of the University during that semester/session.
    2. has registered himself/herself for the courses of study and has attended at least 75% of the lectures/laboratory work and completed the course work to the satisfaction of the department concerned.
    3. has paid all prescribed fees and dues of the semester/session before the commencement of the terminal examinations.
    4. The student falling short of the required percentage of attendance of lectures/seminars/practical/laboratory demonstrations etc., shall not be allowed to appear in the terminal examination of the concerned course and shall be treated as having Failed in that course by denoting the same with **'SA'**.

EVALUATION AND GRADING

Grade Points and Calculation of Grade Point Average

1. The academic work shall normally be evaluated on the basis of percentage marks obtained and the grade points according to the following grading system:

GRADING TABLE

Grade	Percentage Marks	Grade Points
A	84 and above	4.0
A-	80 – 83	3.67
B+	76 – 79	3.33
B	72 – 75	3.0
B-	68 – 71	2.67
C+	64 – 67	2.33
C	60 – 63	2.0
F	Less than 60	0
W	Withdrawal	
R	Replaced Grade	
Imp	Improvement	Grade awarded as per marks
I	Incomplete	

1. Marks will be rounded off for each course only once after adding in semester and final examination marks. Marks would be rounded up / down from first decimal as under:
   - If first decimal is equal to or greater than 5, the value is to be rounded up to next higher whole number e.g. 67.5 will be treated as 68 and 69.5 will be treated as 70.
   - If first decimal is less than 5, the value is to be rounded down to the current whole number e.g. 67.4 will be treated as 67 and 69.4 will be treated as 69.
2. The Semester Grade Point Average (SGPA) and Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) shall be calculated using the following relationships:

$$\text{SGPA} = \frac{\sum \text{Course Credit Hours in the semester (excluding W and I) x Grade Points Earned}}{\text{Total Semester Credit Hours (excluding W and I)}}$$

$$\text{CGPA} = \frac{\sum \text{Course Credit Hours in all semesters (excluding W, I \& R) x Grade Points Earned}}{\text{Total Credit Hours taken in all semesters (excluding W, I \& R)}}$$

1. SGPA and CGPA shall be rounded off up to two decimal places when shown on the transcript and in record(s) of result.
2. The result of student in each course, whether passed or failed, shall be indicated on the transcript by letter grade.

Withdrawal of Course and Grade 'W'

1. A student shall be allowed to withdraw from a course upto 12th week after the start of the classes in the semester. The withdrawn courses shall appear on the transcript with letter grade „W".
2. For the courses with co-requisites (for example, courses with theory as well as lab work), if a student withdraws one component of such a course then it shall be deemed as he/she has withdrawn the whole course.
3. The student shall pay the prescribed fees and other dues of the withdrawn course(s) for the semester/session till the date of withdrawal.
4. No credits shall be given to the withdrawn course(s) and it shall not be used in the SGPA and CGPA calculations.
5. The student may repeat the withdrawn course whenever offered next. He/she shall attend all the classes / tutorial and shall appear in all quizzes/mid semester test(s)/assignment(s)/group discussion(s)/ presentation(s)/project(s) during the semester/session and terminal examination at the end of the semester/session.
6. He/she shall pay the dues for repeating the withdrawal course(s).

Grade 'F'

1. If a student fails to appear in the terminal examination of a course, he/she be treated as absent and failed.
2. The minimum pass marks for each course shall be 60. A student obtaining less than 60 marks in any course shall be deemed to have failed in that course.
3. The grade point for the Grade „F" shall be 0 and it will be used in the SGPA and CGPA calculations.
4. Whenever a student fails in a course, he/she shall repeat the course as soon as the course is offered to improve his/her grade. He/she is required to attend all the classes / tutorial and shall appear in all quizzes/ mid semester test(s) /assignment(s) /group discussion(s) /presentations /project(s) during the semester and terminal examination at the end of the semester.
5. He/she shall pay the dues for repeating the failed course(s).

Grade 'I'

1. If a student fails to appear in the terminal examination of a course on medical or any other reasons, he/she be treated as absent and failed. However, in special circumstances (refer to part 7d.ii), on the request of the student, the Dean of the Faculty concerned, on the recommendations of the HOD/Chairman concerned, may allow for the award of Grade „I" to the student in a course provided that the attendance and other requirements of the course have been completed by the student.
2. No credits shall be given to the Grade „I" and it shall not be used in the SGPA and CGPA calculations.
3. The unfinished requirements must be met no later than the end of the next regular semester; otherwise it will automatically be changed to an "F". It will be responsibility of the student to complete the specified requirements within the stipulated time as approved by the Dean on recommendations of teacher/supervisor.
4. If project is split into 2 parts then "I" will be written in the 1st part and it will be replaced by the original grade in the 2nd part.

Repeating Courses /Improvement of CGPA

1. A student may be allowed to repeat a course in which he/she has obtained grade "C" or "F". A maximum of nine (12) credit hours of coursework may be allowed to a student to repeat for improvement.

2. The student repeating a course shall be required to register the course as a regular course and shall meet all requirements (as perpolicy) such as attending the classes and appear in all the examinations during the semester/session and the terminal examinations of the course.

3. The course repeated in a subsequent semester(s)/session(s) shall be shown in the transcript corresponding to the respective semester(s)/session(s) for as many times as it is registered for. The old grade of the course shall be replaced with the letter grade "R" without changing the previous SGPA/CGPA. The new grade, through its corresponding semester/session, shall be used for computation of the SGPA/CGPA. In case, the new grade is lower than the previous grade then the previous grade shall be retained as such; whereas the new (lower) grade shall be marked as "W" without affecting the SGPA/CGPA and the repeat shall be reflected in the transcript corresponding to the respective semester/session.

4. If a student, after approval of the Dean, takes a new elective course in lieu of a previous elective course in which he/she has failed then the grade of the previous course shall be replaced with the letter grade "R" without changing the previous SGPA/CGPA. Both the previous and the substituted courses shall be reflected in the transcript corresponding to their respective semester/session and only the grade of the substituting course, through its corresponding semester/session, shall be used in computation of the GPA/CGPA. Withdrawal of a substituting course shall not change the grade of the previous course as well as the previous SGPA/CGPA.

5. A student may be allowed to improve his/her CGPA after completion of the program by repeating course(s), with the approval of the Rector on recommendations of the HOD/In-Charge Postgraduate Programs through the Dean, provided the maximum allowable time of the program is not over and that he/she has not been issued the award (degree). The student shall have to surrender his/her previous transcript(s), provisional certificate and other related document(s).

Academic Deficiency

1. A student shall be required to maintain a minimum CGPA of 2.5 throughout the period of study of the program. Whenever the CGPA falls below 2.5 the student shall be given an academic warning for the next semester and this effect shall be published on his/her semester result. Maximum two academic warnings -viz., (i) the "First Probation" and (ii) the "Last Probation" shall be allowed. If the CGPA of a student falls below 2.5 for the third time during the period of study of the program, he/she shall be dismissed from the program and shall not be readmitted in the same program.

2. A student on a probation status shall not be allowed to register the courses of the subsequent/advanced semester unless otherwise permitted by the Dean on recommendations of the Supervisor/Academic Advisor through the HOD/In-Charge Postgraduate Program.

Re-Checking of Answer Books

1. There shall be no re-evaluation/ re-assessment of the answer books.

2. A student may, on the payment of fee as prescribed by the University, get the answer book re-checked for totaling and for verification that all questions or parts thereof have been fully marked, in the presence of the concerned teacher, HOD/In-Charge Postgraduate Programs of the concerned department and the Controller of Examinations, within one month from the date of declaration of the result.

3. Errors or omissions, if any, shall be rectified

REGISTRATION/ENROLLMENT OF RESEARCH WORK, DEVELOPMENT OF SYNOPSIS, APPOINTMENT OF SUPERVISOR

- The research work shall be registered as a regular course in the beginning of the third semester at the maximum. The student shall deposit the prescribed fees and dues on account of registration/enrollment and examinations of his/her research work on the semester/session basis to maintain his/her candidature for the research work for the given semester/session.

- The student shall prepare a synopsis (research proposal) of his/her research work in consultation with the (proposed) supervisor within a period of two months of registration and enrollment for research. The synopsis shall normally be prepared after successful completion of the coursework. The synopsis shall include the topic of research, the name and consent of the (proposed) supervisor and the time period for submission of the thesis within the prescribed time limits.

- The student shall submit his/her synopsis with the consent of the supervisor to the concerned HOD/In-Charge for consideration and permission of the departmental Research Ethics Committee (REC). The REC shall forward its recommendations to the Dean within fifteen days of submission of the synopsis.
    1. Department (if required) may conduct a proposal defense through Faculty Research Board within 15 days after approval of Research Ethics Committee.
    2. If a student fails to defend his proposal twice, department may advise (as per HECs rules and recommendations) the student to opt for two courses in lieu of thesis.
- The approved titles of synopsis alongwith names of supervisors shall be forwarded to the Registrar by the Dean for endorsement of the BASR.
- A co-supervisor may also be appointed by the BASR if the research work involves or becomes interdisciplinary or other particular circumstances so desire.
- The supervisor and co-supervisor (if any) shall be from the relevant field and meet the HEC"s criteria for supervisor appointment.
- The research work shall appear in transcript with the credit hours, the letter grade earned and approved title of research work. The grade shall be used in calculating the CGPA.
- If the student fails to complete his/her research work within the stipulated time as mentioned in the approved synopsis, the Dean may on the recommendation of the supervisor concerned permit the student to complete the thesis within two months. No fee shall be charged for this extended period.
- After two months, if the student could not submit the thesis, 6 credit hours fee shall be charged for each period of extension. Provided further that the extension(s) shall not be given beyond the maximum time period allowed for the program. Provided also that the student shall deposit the prescribed fees and other dues for the extended period(s).
- In exceptional cases, one year extension in maximum permissible period can be granted by the BASR on the recommendations of the Dean concerned.
- In case a major/entire change in the approved research topic/subject is required the case shall be considered afresh. The reason of change and the change shall be forwarded to the BASR for consideration and approval following the due procedures. However, time limits of the program shall not be changed in any case.
- Progress of the student shall be monitored on six monthly basis on a format devised by the QEC.

CONDITIONS FOR SUBMISSION OF THESIS

The thesis submitted by the student shall comply with the following conditions:

- It shall be certified and signed by the supervisor and the co-supervisor (if any) that the contents mentioned are accurate to the best level.
- It shall form a distinct contribution to knowledge and afford evidence of originality, shown by the discovery of new facts, by the exercise of independent critical judgment, and/or by the invention of new methods of investigation.
- It shall not include research work for which a degree has already been conferred in this University or any other University/DAI.
- It shall be written in English for all subjects except the oriental languages, in which case it shall be either the language itself or English, or otherwise as approved by the BASR on recommendations of the supervisor forwarded by the Dean.
- It shall have the format, writing, referencing, paper, binding and other related matters as approved by the BASR from time to time.

THESIS DEFENSE/ VIVA VOCE

- There shall be a standing list of external examiners (not in service of the department/University) for each department consisting of persons of eminence (local examiner) in the respective field of research. The list shall be suggested from time to time by the concerned Board of Studies and Board of Faculty for approval of the BASR.
- The student shall submit an electronic copy of the thesis upon completion through his/her supervisor to the HOD/In-Charge Postgraduate Program for plagiarism check (as per University's Plagiarism policy).
- After getting clearance of plagiarism check, the student shall submit copies of his/her complete thesis to the Controller of Examinations through his/her supervisor and the department for the evaluation by the external examiner.
- The Supervisor shall inform the COE through the department about the date of viva voce examination and suggest two to three names of external examiners from the approved list.
- The Controller of Examinations, in consultation with Dean, shall forward one copy of the thesis to one of the external examiners along with the information related to the date, time and venue of the viva-voce examination.
- The viva-voce examination committee shall comprise of the external examiner, internal examiner (if any) and the HOD/In-Charge Postgraduate Programs. HOD will act as facilitator of the viva-voce examination committee.

- If the student fails to satisfy the examiners in the viva-voce examination, he/she may be given one chance to defend the thesis for the second and final time within a period of four months from the date of viva-voce examination. If the student fails to satisfy the examiners on the second viva-voce examination then concerned department may allow the candidate to register and pass two courses in lieu of thesis within the maximum completion time of program.
- Upon successful conduct of Viva Voce/ Open Defense the student shall be required to incorporate the suggested changes and resubmit a revised version of the thesis, duly certified by the supervisor.
- The student shall submit four hard bound copies to COE. The COE, after affixing his/her signatures to declare the copy of the thesis as final, shall forward one copy each to the Supervisor, Student, and Library for record. COE will retain one copy for their record.
- Two hard bound copies shall be printed on A4 size (8.27" × 11.69") paper and shall have black hard binding with golden lettering on the front and the spine.
- A student who successfully completes all the requirements of the program shall be awarded the degree under the seal of the University.

FEES AND OTHER DUES

Each student shall be required to pay tuition fee and such other charges of the program as may be determined by the Department and approved by the University from time to time.

APPLICABILITY

- The above regulations shall come into force with effect from date of approval by the Academic Council.
- The revised version shall remain in field until amended/ modified or repealed by the Competent Authority.

REPEAL

The existing regulations shall stand repealed on notification of revised version 4.0. However, the matters of all the batches who have attempted any examination during the Spring Semester 2022 shall remain valid till the commencement of next semester.

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SUPERIOR UNIVERSITY
OFFICE OF THE REGISTRAR

17-KM Raiwind Road, Lahore (Pakistan)

Dated: 13th June, 2022

Notification

No. SC/AC/38/1-2. On the recommendations of the Deans' Committee, the **Academic** Council, in its 38th meeting held on 13-05-2022 has approved the following regulations and policies for implementation w.e.f. Fall 2022.

- **Academic Regulations for the Undergraduate Programs** version 4.0 (Annex-A).
- **Academic Regulations for the MS/MPhil Programs** version 4.0 (Annex- B).
- **Scholarship Award Policy 2022** (Annex-C).
- **Admission Policy 2022** {Undergraduate (Annex-D) and Postgraduate Programs (Annex-E) }

-sd- REGISTRAR/
SECRETARY ACADEMIC COUNCIL

No. and Date Even.

Copy is forwarded for information and necessary action to:

1. Pro-Rector/ All Deans of Faculties/Directors of Campuses
2. All Heads of the teaching Departments
3. Director Admissions
4. Director Engagement and Communication
5. Controller of Examinations
6. Deputy Director (QEC/Automation)
7. Director, Marketing
8. All deputy Registrars
9. In-Charge, Students Support Office
10. Accounts Office
11. Notification File

Deputy Registrar (Academics)

Automation and Policy Control Department

The Automation and Policy Control Department at Superior University Lahore plays a critical role in managing and optimizing institutional processes by focusing on two major projects: ERP (Enterprise Resource Planning) and ODL (Open and Distance Learning). Through the implementation of ERP, the department streamlines administrative, academic, and financial operations, ensuring efficient resource management and data-driven decision-making. Simultaneously, the department supports the ODL initiative, enabling flexible and accessible education for a diverse student body through the integration of technology-enhanced learning platforms and robust policy frameworks. This dual focus ensures that Superior University remains at the forefront of innovation in both administrative efficiency and educational accessibility.

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